

Wealthy back question on primaries — but why?

Their foes say it's all about money, but supporters point to idealistic reasons

By Chris Van Buskirk
GLOBE STAFF

The campaign to get rid of Massachusetts' partisan primaries has a fairly consistent type of donor.

There's \$250,000 in contributions from John Connaughton, the chairman of Bain Capital, one of the world's largest investment firms. Andrew Balson, a former Bain executive who started his own private equity firm, has given nearly \$800,000, while Mark Nunnally, another Bain alum, has chipped in a half-million dollars.

David "Randy" Peeler, who for years held a top position at Berkshire Partners, another private equity firm, has contributed more than \$1 million.

They are part of a cohort of wealthy individuals with ties to various investment, private equity, and venture capital firms who have collectively contributed millions to the campaign pushing the ballot question. The donations have made the Coalition for Healthy Democracy the top-funded ballot question campaign this election cycle, though it is unclear why they are contributing in such large amounts.

Nearly \$500,000 has flowed from those who identified as working for Bain Capital, records show. Another \$250,000 came from others at Berkshire Partners beyond Peeler, who is listed as a senior adviser there. All told, the commit-

DONORS, Page A5

Putting the state's energy future into words

JON CHESTO
COMMENTARY

Here we go again. The business and environmental lobbies are at odds on Beacon Hill — and this time the fight's over a tiny, blink-and-you'll-miss-it section in a 170-page energy bill.

The controversial measure in question, approved by the Senate, would give legal cover to utilities to end natural gas service if they're directed to do so by state regulators, as long as alternatives exist. What alternatives? While geothermal is an option, we're mostly talking about electric heat.

Forcing people to switch from gas to electricity for heat, business leaders argue, gets expensive quickly because of conversion costs. The environmentalists disagree, particularly when factoring in the upkeep of the gas system, and claim a 2024 energy law already gives state officials this power anyway. The issue revolves around the state's "obligation to serve" that has blocked utilities from ending service to existing gas customers without their consent.

ENERGY, Page A6

1 diocese still resists naming priests

Worcester bishop's stance on accused abusers angers survivors

By Brian MacQuarrie
GLOBE STAFF

For years, Worcester Bishop Robert McManus has balked at disclosing the names of all the priests in his diocese who had been credibly accused of abusing children, standing alone in opposition among the state's four Catholic leaders.

Now, McManus is under pressure to publicly release the names of every accused priest following a withering state report this week on sexu-

al abuse by hundreds of Catholic clergy in Massachusetts.

In her blockbuster report released Wednesday, Attorney General Andrea Campbell found 90 clergy who had been accused of abuse in the Worcester diocese and 216 survivors, although she cautioned that investigators had not assessed the accusations for credibility.

Campbell, as well as survivors and watchdog groups, said disclosing their names is an important

driver for healing and institutional accountability.

"It's been business as usual: Protect the church at all costs," said Dave Lewcon, 72, who said he was sexually abused as a teenager by a priest at St. Mary's Church in Uxbridge, which is in the Worcester diocese.

But the 75-year-old McManus has yet to waver from his decision to keep the names private.

He has, however, noted that the

diocese in recent years reported every allegation to law enforcement and that church officials publish information on the diocesan website about every priest who has been placed on leave due to a credible report of abuse or who has been removed from clerical duties.

A spokesperson for McManus, Ray Delisle, added that "we will study the AG's report to identify any additional improvements that can be made to respond to victims of past abuse and to continue to

WORCESTER, Page A6

AVENUE OF BROKEN TRUST

A welcome, yet feared, development

No one's quite sure what an improved Blue Hill Ave. would mean, but businesses in Black Boston wonder if they'll find themselves pushed out



Third in a series.

By Katie Johnston
GLOBE STAFF

Skye Warren grew up just off Blue Hill Avenue in Mattapan, within walking distance of a roller skating rink and a pizza place. Her short one-way street was the site of blow-out block parties where she and her friends performed dance routines and bands performed on a stage set up in front of her house. That brick-red triple decker, purchased by her grandparents in the 1960s, was the center of her family's universe, the north star guiding everyone home.

Today Warren, 31, is trying to make her way back. She owns a beauty business in Milton but is trying to buy a commercial space to move it to a few blocks from her childhood home. Doing so would put her in a prime position: owning property on Blue Hill Avenue before it gets a \$164 million injection to revitalize the long-neglected commercial corridor linking Mattapan, Dorchester, and Roxbury.

Putting down roots in a neighborhood Warren's family has lived in for generations, closer to her clients' and employees' homes, is about more than being a property owner: It's about investing in the Black community.

BLUE HILL AVENUE, Page A7



TOP: SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF; ABOVE: JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

At top, Skye Warren is aiming to move her beauty business to Mattapan, where her roots are. Getting funding hasn't been easy. Above, Rafael Diaz waited for his car in an area owned by the Stamatos family, one of the biggest property owners on Blue Hill Avenue.

Sox caught resting on their laurels

Easing up on the gas in September left them sluggish when it counted



FRANK FRANKLIN II/ASSOCIATED PRESS

It was a familiar sight over the two nights — a Red Sox player trudging back to the dugout after striking out.

PETER ABRAHAM
COMMENTARY

You know that feeling when you show up for work on Monday after a vacation? That's how the Red Sox looked against the Yankees in the American League Wild Card Series.

A step slow and lacking energy; like everybody was waiting for tech support to reset their password so they could get back to work.

It showed up on the scoreboard at Yankee Stadium with a 9-0 loss in Game 1 on Tuesday and a season-ending 9-2 loss in Game 2 on Wednesday.

The Yankees scored 18 runs over 16 innings without star slugger Aaron Judge in their lineup. The Red Sox bullpen allowed 15 of those runs.

Offensively, the Red Sox struck out 19 times in 60 plate appearances and had four extra-base hits, three of them by Willson Contreras.

ABRAHAM, Page C4

A woman was killed and two people were injured when a vehicle crashed into a building on the campus of Brigham and Women's Faulkner Hospital. **B1.**

A judge denied Lindsay Clancy's request for a directed verdict of not guilty, ruling that prosecutors presented sufficient evidence for a jury to find her criminally responsible. **B1.**

A woman was in critical condition after a failed attempt to execute her pushed Tennessee's governor to halt further executions this year. **A2.**

A federal lawsuit was filed against DraftKings, alleging it uses predatory AI models that promote gambling addiction for profit. **B5.**



Sunscreen time

Friday: Summery. High 80-85. Low 56-61.

Saturday: Sunny but cooler. High 67-72. Low 49-54.

High tide: 3:50 a.m., 4:04 p.m.

Sunrise: 6:42 Sunset: 6:24

Weather and Comics, G6-7.

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